

Call Prep

Line Axia

Olivia Aréchiga, CTO · 10 questions · plain answers

- Q1 Are you ready to deploy?
- Q2 Can it run in Europe?
- Q3 How much of your time does this take?
- Q4 Can you fit this in right now?
- Q5 Any third-party software to worry about?
- Q6 How do you want to be paid?
- Q7 Who does what in this deal?
- Q8 Who owns the technology?
- Q9 Is 12-month exclusivity fair?
- Q10 What do you need before saying yes?

- A Hard follow-up questions she might ask
- B Questions Jesse should ask
- C Things NOT to say
- D Risk scores

WHAT SHE'S REALLY ASKING

Is this real software or just a demo — and how long until it's in front of a real client?

ANSWER

The software works. 372 tests pass. 15 separate checks all pass. There's a live demo she can look at right now.

Two things not done yet: the audit log disappears if the server restarts (fix needed before any pilot), and no real deployment has happened outside the demo.

Pilot-ready means: one client, one use case, no live decisions, written agreement before any real data.

WATCH OUT

She may say "VeraSeal." That word does not exist anywhere in the codebase. Say: "You might be thinking of CerbaSeal — that's the system." Then move on. Do not invent a definition.

IF SHE CUTS YOU OFF — ONE SENTENCE

"The core software works and is tested — the only gap before a pilot is saving the audit log, which is a small fix."

WHAT SHE'S REALLY ASKING

For EU clients, data leaving Europe is a legal problem, not just a preference. She needs to know if this is already solved.

ANSWER

The software makes zero calls to any outside service. No cloud. No APIs. No data leaves wherever you install it. It would run in a European data centre exactly as it runs anywhere else.

That said — no actual EU deployment has happened yet. The first one would happen as part of a pilot, with the client controlling their own hosting.

WATCH OUT

Don't say "it works in EU" — say "it's designed to work in EU, and the first deployment would happen as part of the pilot." Those are different claims.

IF SHE CUTS YOU OFF — ONE SENTENCE

"The software makes no external calls and works wherever Node.js runs — the first EU deployment would be the pilot itself."

WHAT SHE'S REALLY ASKING

Is the client dependent on Jesse being around all the time? What if he's unavailable?

ANSWER

Week 1 is the heaviest: about 10–15 hours. Setup, deployment, documents, one 60-minute call.

After that: a 30-minute call each week, issue tracking, email responses.

Response times are written down: urgent issues same day, rule problems within 24 hours, general questions within 3 days.

The system explains itself — every blocked action gives a reason in plain English. It's designed to run without Jesse once it's set up.

WATCH OUT

One person. No backup engineer. Honest about that: up to 48 hours without Jesse, everything still runs. Beyond 48 hours, there's no formal plan. Name this before she brings it up.

IF SHE CUTS YOU OFF — ONE SENTENCE

"Week one is about 10–15 hours from me, then 3–5 hours a week after that, with written response times for anything that comes up."

WHAT SHE'S REALLY ASKING

Are there competing projects? Is there a better time to start?

ANSWER

No other active pilots. This would be the first.

Time needed: 10–15 hours in week one, 3–5 hours a week after that.

One thing to factor in: the audit log fix needs to happen before the pilot starts. That's about 2–5 days of work. It goes into the start timeline.

[Jesse adds any specific scheduling notes here.]

WATCH OUT

Don't imply unlimited capacity. One person, real constraints.

IF SHE CUTS YOU OFF — ONE SENTENCE

"No competing pilots — this is the first — and the only pre-start item is a short fix that goes into the timeline."

WHAT SHE'S REALLY ASKING

Does CerbaSeal bring in outside software that could create licence problems or security concerns for EU clients?

ANSWER

The enforcement library — the thing a client actually installs — has zero external packages. Nothing comes with it. A security team reviewing it only needs to look at Node.js and CerbaSeal's own code.

The demo site uses one package called tsx (MIT licence). That's only in the demo, not in anything a client installs.

Every licence in the project is MIT. No restrictions, no obligations, no copyleft.

WATCH OUT

Be precise: zero dependencies in the library. One package in the demo. These are different things.

IF SHE CUTS YOU OFF — ONE SENTENCE

"The enforcement library has zero external packages — nothing ships with it — and every licence in the project is MIT."

WHAT SHE'S REALLY ASKING

Has Jesse thought about this seriously? Does his model create awkward incentives?

ANSWER

A fixed fee for a defined pilot is the cleanest model. The scope is written down. Both sides know exactly what they're paying for.

Anything outside the agreed scope gets priced separately.

Do not anchor a number before knowing what Line Axia is making on this deal.

WATCH OUT

If the advisory partner is keeping most of the commercial fee, Jesse needs to know that before agreeing to anything. Ask about their structure first.

IF SHE CUTS YOU OFF — ONE SENTENCE

"A fixed fee for a defined scope — I just want to understand your fee structure first so the numbers line up."

WHAT SHE'S REALLY ASKING

She's proposing: Line Axia handles the client, regulations, commercial. Lamont Labs builds and runs the technology. Does that work?

ANSWER

Broadly yes — but "technical implementation" needs a real definition.

What Lamont Labs does: delivers and runs CerbaSeal, tracks issues, produces documents, owns the code.

What Lamont Labs does NOT do: legal or compliance opinions, plugging into client's existing systems, managing the client relationship, making commitments when Jesse isn't in the room.

WATCH OUT

Line Axia cannot make technical commitments on Jesse's behalf. Any technical scope goes through Jesse. This must be in writing.

IF SHE CUTS YOU OFF — ONE SENTENCE

"That works, as long as we define exactly what 'technical implementation' includes and who can make technical commitments."

WHAT SHE'S REALLY ASKING

Are there hidden complications — shared ownership, open-source obligations, anything that could cause problems?

ANSWER

Lamont Labs owns all of it. The licence in the repository is proprietary — looking at it or using the demo doesn't give anyone any rights.

No third-party code in the enforcement library. All original work. No obligations.

Audit records produced during a pilot belong to the client. Lamont Labs keeps no access to client data after the engagement ends.

WATCH OUT

One thing to settle in the agreement: who owns custom configuration built specifically for a client? The core technology is Lamont Labs'. Client-specific setup needs a clear answer.

IF SHE CUTS YOU OFF — ONE SENTENCE

"Lamont Labs owns the technology outright — proprietary licence, no third-party IP, and client evidence records go to the client."

WHAT SHE'S REALLY ASKING

She wants to lock down CerbaSeal in the EU market before anyone else gets access. She's also testing whether Jesse will just say yes.

ANSWER

Exclusivity is worth discussing. But "12-month EU exclusivity" needs real answers before Jesse agrees:

- What counts as EU? France? All 27 countries?
- What starts the clock? The agreement? The first pilot?
- What keeps it active? A minimum number of pilots? A revenue floor?
- What's the right of first refusal actually on?

CerbaSeal works and is tested. Exclusivity has value to Line Axia. That value should show up somewhere in the deal.

WATCH OUT

Do not agree to anything on this call. "That sounds like a reasonable starting point" is fine. "Yes, agreed" is not. No minimum activity clause = Jesse can't develop the EU market for a year even if nothing happens.

IF SHE CUTS YOU OFF — ONE SENTENCE

"Exclusivity is worth exploring — I just need the specific terms defined before I can agree to anything."

WHAT SHE'S REALLY ASKING

She's asking Jesse to reveal his priorities before negotiation starts. Prepared answer = confidence.
Unprepared = weakness.

ANSWER

Five things. All documented:

1. Who owns the evidence — client keeps everything, Lamont Labs keeps nothing.
2. Written scope — exactly what's in and what's out, with a process for anything extra.
3. Liability limit — CerbaSeal sits before decisions are made, not responsible for what happens after.
4. Defined support period — start date, end date, what support covers.
5. Agreed governing law — which country's law applies.

WATCH OUT

Know the one thing that would make Jesse walk away from this deal before the call starts.

IF SHE CUTS YOU OFF — ONE SENTENCE

"Five things in writing: evidence ownership, scope boundary, liability limit, support period, and governing law."

Section A — Hard Follow-Up Questions

Questions Olivia might ask after the 10 main ones. Know these before the call.

"Can you show it running on our servers, not your demo?"

! Not yet. The pilot would be the first real deployment outside the demo.

"What happens to the audit log if the server restarts?"

! Right now it's lost. Fixing this is the first thing before any pilot starts.

"Has anyone outside your team reviewed the security?"

! No external firm has reviewed it. The security brief is honest about every limitation.

"Does it actually understand the policy documents it references?"

! No — it checks a reference exists. Understanding the content happens upstream.

"Could the audit trail be faked?"

! It's hash-linked, which proves nothing changed. Cryptographic signing is a future item.

"What's your GDPR analysis?"

! Not done. Legal review must happen before any real data is involved.

"What if it sees a request type it doesn't recognise?"

! It blocks it. The system always fails closed — never lets something through when unsure.

"What does a failed pilot look like?"

! Findings report, everything returned to client, fees as agreed upfront.

"What's your day rate?"

! Jesse answers. Know the number before the call.

"Could we buy CerbaSeal after 12 months?"

! Separate conversation. Don't answer live.

"Are you talking to other advisory partners?"

! Jesse answers. Know your position.

"Have you spoken with EU regulators about the AI Act?"

!' No. CerbaSeal supports audit requirements. No regulatory conversations have occurred.

"Is this evidence admissible in a French court?"

!' That requires a legal opinion. The evidence is consistent and documented — admissibility depends on jurisdiction.

Section B — Questions Jesse Should Ask

Ask at least the first three. These reveal what Jesse needs to know before agreeing to anything.

1. "Who is the specific client — and what's their actual problem?"

Tells you if there's a real client or just a hypothesis.

2. "What's Line Axia's fee structure — and what does the technical partner typically receive?"

Must know the economics before agreeing to any commercial term.

3. "What does Tina Simpson's review process look like and when does it happen?"

Understand the legal gate before committing to a timeline.

4. "Has Line Axia done a pilot with an early-stage founder before?"

Due diligence on the partner.

5. "If the pilot works — what's the next stage?"

Know the upside before trading 12 months of EU market access.

6. "Can Line Axia make technical commitments without me in the room?"

Must be no. Every technical scope goes through Jesse.

7. "What minimum activity keeps the exclusivity active?"

No floor = no accountability.

8. "What governing law are you proposing?"

Don't leave this open.

9. "Is there a cap on my liability?"

Solo founder in an enterprise deal needs a ceiling.

Section C — Things NOT to Say

Every one of these is false, overstates what exists, or gives up negotiating ground.

"VeraSeal is our first component..." — that word does not exist in the codebase.

"We've already deployed in European environments." — not yet.

"The audit log is fully saved and persistent." — it disappears on restart.

"A third-party security firm has reviewed this." — they have not.

"We're almost production-ready." — there's a documented gap.

Agreeing to exclusivity terms on this call.

Naming a compensation number before knowing Line Axia's fee structure.

"I can build whatever you need during the pilot." — out-of-scope work is priced separately.

"The evidence chain is cryptographically signed." — it's hash-linked. Different thing.

"We have other interested clients." — don't create false pressure.

"CerbaSeal is GDPR or AI Act compliant." — no compliance analysis has been done.

Open-ended support with no defined end date.

Section D — Risk Scores

How prepared does Jesse need to be for each question?

Q1 Ready to deploy?

MEDIUM

The VeraSeal correction is the only real trap. Answer honestly about the audit log gap and it's fine.

Q2 Can it run in Europe?

MEDIUM

Architecture is clean. Just be precise: designed for EU "``" deployed in EU yet.

Q3 How much of your time?

LOW

Fully documented. Know what's in the support model and this is easy.

Q4 Can you fit this in?

LOW

Simple. Just be honest about being one person.

Q5 Third-party software?

LOW

Zero dependencies in the library. Good story. Low risk.

Q6 How to be paid?

HIGH

No number before knowing their fee structure. Highest risk of the call.

Q7 Who does what?

MEDIUM

Risk is agreeing to vague scope. Push for a specific example before saying yes.

Q8 Who owns the technology?

LOW

Clean position. Licence is clear.

Q9 12-month exclusivity?

HIGH

Most consequential question. Do not agree on the call. No minimum clause = bad deal.

Q10 What do you need?

MEDIUM

Opportunity if prepared. The five requirements are documented — name them without hesitation.